

KEY TOPIC 2 CHRONOLOGICAL ENQUIRY SEQUENCE • 1569–1588**Challenges to Elizabeth at Home and Abroad, 1569–88***Catholic Plots, Mary's Execution, Spanish Rivalry & The Armada*

HISTORICAL PRIMARY RECORD • C. 1588

WOBURN ABBEY COLLECTION • BEDFORDSHIRE • WA-INV-042

The Armada Portrait of Queen Elizabeth I

Attributed to George Gower • Queen Elizabeth I sits in triumph with her right hand resting on a global orb. Behind her, windows depict the English fireships assaulting the Spanish fleet at Gravelines and the Armada wrecked on stormy rocks. Accession Shelfmark WA-INV-042.

HISTORICAL PRIMARY SOURCE

EDEXCEL PAPER 2 MASTER ARCHIVE

PUPIL WORKBOOK & ASSESSMENT

PEARSON EDEXCEL GCSE (9–1) HISTORY • PAPER 2: EARLY ELIZABETHAN ENGLAND, 1558–1588
• KEY TOPIC 2

NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

PEARSON EDEXCEL GCSE (9–1) HISTORY SPECIFICATION CONTENT**OFFICIAL SPECIFICATION CONTENT****1. PLOTS AND REVOLTS AT HOME**

- Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569) & papal bull *Regnans in Excelsis* (1570)
- The Ridolfi Plot (1571), Throckmorton Plot (1583) & Babington Plot (1586)
- Sir Francis Walsingham's spy network, cipher decoders & agent provocateurs
- Execution of Mary, Queen of Scots (1587) at Fotheringhay Castle

2. RELATIONS WITH SPAIN

- Political & religious rivalry between Protestant England and Catholic Spain
- Commercial rivalry in the New World & English privateering (Sir Francis Drake)
- The Dutch Revolt (1566–84) & Elizabeth's policy of covert financial support
- Treaty of Nonsuch (1585) & direct military intervention under Robert Dudley

3. OUTBREAK OF WAR & THE ARMADA

- Drake's raid on Cadiz (1587): "Singeing the King of Spain's Beard"
- Philip II's invasion plan: Medina Sidonia & Duke of Parma's Army of Flanders
- English naval advantages: Hawkins' race-built galleons & rapid-fire culverins
- Fireships at Calais, Battle of Gravelines (1588), and Spanish defeat

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 2)

Instructions: As you study each enquiry lesson, complete the timeline missions by sketching and annotating in the corresponding dual-coding sketchpads below.

NOV 1569 • Revolt of the Northern Earls

Key Topic 2.1

Catholic Earls of Northumberland and Westmorland march on Durham Cathedral, tear up English bibles, and restore the Latin Mass with 4,600 men. Royal troops march north; the rebellion collapses and Elizabeth executes 450 rebels to crush northern disobedience.

FEB 1570 • Papal Bull *Regnans in Excelsis*

Key Topic 2.1

Pope Pius V issues a papal bull excommunicating Elizabeth, declaring her a 'pretended queen' and heretic. Crucially, the Pope releases all Catholic subjects from their oath of allegiance, making it a sacred Catholic duty to overthrow the Queen.

1571–1583 • The Ridolfi and Throckmorton Plots

Key Topic 2.1

Italian banker Roberto Ridolfi plans a Spanish invasion by the Duke of Alba to marry Mary to the Duke of Norfolk. In 1583, French Catholic Francis Throckmorton coordinates a planned invasion backed by Spain and the Pope. Walsingham uncovers both.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 2)

Instructions: Complete the dual-coding sketches to permanently anchor these chronological turning points in long-term memory.

AUG 1585 • The Treaty of Nonsuch & Open War with Spain

Key Topic 2.3

Following the assassination of Dutch Protestant leader William of Orange, Elizabeth signs the Treaty of Nonsuch with Dutch rebels, agreeing to send 7,400 troops under Robert Dudley. This ends decades of cold war and triggers open military conflict with Spain.

1586–FEB 1587 • The Babington Plot & Execution of Mary Stuart

Key Topic 2.1

Anthony Babington sends coded letters in beer barrels to Mary Stuart agreeing to assassinate Elizabeth. Walsingham's codebreaker Thomas Phelippes intercepts Mary's endorsement. Mary is convicted of high treason and beheaded at Fotheringhay Castle on 8 Feb 1587.

APR 1587–AUG 1588 • Drake at Cadiz & Defeat of the Spanish Armada

Key Topic 2.4

Drake raids Cadiz harbour, destroying 30 Spanish ships ('singeing the King's beard') and delaying the Armada by a year. In July 1588, 130 Spanish ships enter the Channel. English fireships break their formation at Calais; Gravelines artillery seals English victory.

Why did every Catholic plot to assassinate Elizabeth end in catastrophic failure?

Key Topic 2.1: Northern Earls, Ridolfi, Throckmorton, Babington & Walsingham's Spies

Key Specification Focus: The Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569); plots: Ridolfi (1571), Throckmorton (1583), Babington (1586); Walsingham's network of spies; execution of Mary Queen of Scots (1587).

• 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL DRILL (10 RECALL QUESTIONS)

Score: [/ 10]

1. Which two northern Catholic earls led the 1569 rebellion?

2. Which Catholic cathedral did the Northern Earls seize to celebrate the Latin Mass?

3. What papal bull excommunicated Elizabeth I in 1570?

4. Which English duke was executed in 1572 for his role in the Ridolfi Plot?

5. Who was Queen Elizabeth's Spymaster General from 1573?

6. How did plotters smuggle coded messages to Mary Stuart during the Babington Plot?

7. What skilled cryptographer decoded Mary Stuart's letters for Walsingham?

8. What 1584 document pledged to execute anyone who attempted to assassinate Elizabeth?

9. In which castle was Mary, Queen of Scots beheaded on 8 February 1587?

10. Approximately how many northern rebels did Elizabeth execute after the 1569 revolt?

• CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

HISTORICAL TERMINOLOGY

Papal Excommunication: Key Disciplinary Concept | **Agent Provocateur:** Key Disciplinary Concept

Distinguish between the Pope's official decree casting Elizabeth out of the Church and freeing subjects from obedience (**Papal Excommunication**) and a secret government spy who encourages suspects to commit treason to gather proof (**Agent Provocateur**):

Sentence Starter: *While Papal Excommunication established that..., Agent Provocateur operated differently because...*

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

Edexcel June 2018 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of the Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569).

Target Guidance: *Point (A Catholic uprising led by the Earls of Northumberland and Westmorland to restore Catholicism) • Fact (They held a Latin Mass in Durham Cathedral with 4,600 men, but fled when royal troops advanced; 450 rebels were executed).*

Sentence Stems: One key feature was the northern Catholic nobles' attempt to overthrow Protestantism... Specifically, they captured Durham Cathedral and...

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

Edexcel June 2023 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of Sir Francis Walsingham's spy network.

Target Guidance: *Point (An extensive intelligence network of spies, informers, codebreakers, and cryptographers) • Fact (Walsingham intercepted letters, cracked ciphers with Thomas Phelippes, and deployed double agents across England and Europe).*

Sentence Stems: One key feature was Walsingham's systematic interception of secret communications... Specifically, his cryptographer Thomas Phelippes...

EDEXCEL JUNE 2018 (Q2)

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why Mary, Queen of Scots was executed in 1587.

You may use in your answer:

- The Babington Plot (1586)
- Walsingham's spy network

(You must also use information of your own.)

1. CAUSE 1: DIRECT COMPLICITY IN BABINGTON PLOT

POINT
1

Explain that intercepted beer-barrel letters explicitly showed Mary endorsing Anthony Babington's plot to assassinate Elizabeth; Phelippes decoded Mary's letter containing the postmark gallows sign.

2. CAUSE 2: WALSINGHAM & PARLIAMENTARY PRESSURE

POINT
2

Explain that the 1584 Bond of Association legally obligated privy councillors to execute anyone involved in assassination plots; Parliament and Cecil relentlessly lobbied Elizabeth to sign the death warrant.

3. CAUSE 3: ESCALATING SPANISH WAR THREAT

POINT
3

Explain that by 1586 England was at open war with Spain following the Treaty of Nonsuch; keeping Mary alive created an immediate rallying figure for an imminent Spanish invasion of England.

Analytical Connectives: Mary Stuart was executed in 1587 primarily because... • Specifically, Walsingham obtained conclusive forensic evidence when... • Furthermore, under the Bond of Association, Privy Councillors argued that... • In addition, with war looming against Spain, Mary represented... • Consequently, these combined pressures forced Elizabeth to sign the death warrant because...

Word Bank: Mary, Queen of Scots • Babington Plot • Walsingham • Thomas Philippes • Bond of Association • Fotheringhay Castle • High Treason • Ciphers • Philip II

Timeline Mission: Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 5). In Milestone 5, sketch the beer barrel with hidden cipher letters and the execution block at Fotheringhay.

Was war between England and Spain inevitable from the moment Elizabeth took the throne?

Key Topic 2.2: Commercial Rivalry, Privateering, Drake & Religious Conflict

Key Specification Focus: Political and religious rivalry between England and Spain; commercial rivalry in the New World; English privateering and the activities of Sir Francis Drake.

• 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL DRILL (10 RECALL QUESTIONS)

Score: [/ 10]

1. Which Spanish king had previously been married to Elizabeth's sister Mary I?

2. What religion was Philip II, positioning himself as champion of the Counter-Reformation?

3. What Spanish monopoly prohibited English merchants from trading in the Americas?

4. What term describes state-licensed sea captains who raided enemy merchant ships?

5. Which English privateer became the first to circumnavigate the globe (1577–80)?

6. What famous Spanish treasure ship was captured by Drake off Ecuador in 1579?

7. How much silver and treasure did Drake capture from the *Cacafuego*?

8. Where did Elizabeth publicly knight Francis Drake in 1581?

9. Why was Philip II enraged by Elizabeth knighting Francis Drake?

10. What Dutch territory revolted against Philip II's rule in 1566?

• CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

HISTORICAL TERMINOLOGY

Privateering Monopoly: Key Disciplinary Concept | **Sovereign Hegemony:** Key Disciplinary Concept

Distinguish between state-sanctioned commerce raiding against Spanish treasure shipping (**Privateering**) and Philip II's imperial ambition to dominate European politics and religion (**Sovereign Hegemony**):

Sentence Starter: *While Privateering Monopoly established that..., Sovereign Hegemony operated differently because...*

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

Edexcel June 2019 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of commercial rivalry between England and Spain in the New World.

Target Guidance: *Point (Spain held an exclusive trade monopoly on its American colonies that barred English merchants) • Fact (English privateers like John Hawkins and Drake bypassed Spanish licenses to trade illegally and seize Spanish bullion ships).*

Sentence Stems: One key feature was Spanish trade restrictions in the Caribbean... Specifically, Spain banned English merchants, prompting privateers like Drake to...

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

Edexcel November 2021 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of Sir Francis Drake's raid on the Cacafuego (1579).

Target Guidance: *Point (Drake captured Spain's richest treasure galleon in the Pacific during his circumnavigation) • Fact (He seized 80lb of gold, 26 tons of silver, and jewels worth £140,000, bringing it back to Elizabeth on the Golden Hind).*

Sentence Stems: One key feature was the colossal value of the treasure seized... Specifically, Drake intercepted the treasure ship off Ecuador and took...

‘Commercial rivalry in the Americas was the main cause of worsening relations between England and Spain between 1569 and 1585.’ How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

You may use in your answer: • Francis Drake's privateering • Religious conflict (You must also use information of your own.)

1. CRITERIA 1: COMMERCIAL RIVALRY & DRAKE POINT 1 Explain how Drake's raids in the West Indies and Pacific humiliated Philip II; by knighting Drake in 1581 and funding privateers, Elizabeth demonstrated state sponsorship of piracy against Spanish bullion.	2. CRITERIA 2: RELIGIOUS ANTAGONISM POINT 2 Explain that Philip viewed himself as the secular sword of the Catholic Counter-Reformation; the 1570 papal bull excommunicating Elizabeth and Philip's backing of plots (Ridolfi, Throckmorton) made holy war inevitable.	3. CRITERIA 3: THE STRATEGIC NETHERLANDS CRISIS POINT 3 Explain that Spain's military brutality in the Netherlands (Alba and Parma) threatened England's chief wool export market; Spanish control of Channel ports was an intolerable direct invasion threat.
Analytical Connectives: Commercial rivalry was an explosive cause of hostility because... • Specifically, Drake's plundering of Spanish galleons directly attacked Philip's treasury and prestige... • However, religious divisions deepened the clash because Philip believed... • Furthermore, the strategic geopolitical crisis in the Netherlands was arguably more urgent because... • Weighing these factors, I conclude that while commercial piracy provoked constant anger, the Netherlands crisis was the decisive trigger because... Word Bank: Commercial rivalry • Privateers • Francis Drake • *Golden Hind* • *Cacafuego* • Philip II • Netherlands • Papal Bull (1570) • Counter-Reformation		
Timeline Mission: Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 3). In Milestone 3, sketch Drake's ship the *Golden Hind* and the Spanish silver bars.		

Did English intervention in the Netherlands or Drake's raid on Cadiz make the Armada inevitable?

Key Topic 2.3: The Dutch Revolt, Treaty of Nonsuch (1585), Robert Dudley & Cadiz (1587)

Key Specification Focus: The Dutch Revolt and English involvement in the Netherlands (Treaty of Nonsuch, Robert Dudley); Drake's raid on Cadiz (1587) and "Singeing the King of Spain's Beard".

• 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL DRILL (10 RECALL QUESTIONS)

Score: [/ 10]

1. Which Dutch Protestant leader was assassinated by a Catholic fanatic in 1584?

2. What treaty between Philip II and the French Catholic League was signed in 1584?

3. What 1585 treaty committed English troops to fight alongside Dutch rebels?

4. Who was appointed commander of the 7,400 English soldiers sent to the Netherlands?

5. What controversial political title did Robert Dudley accept in the Netherlands, outraging Elizabeth?

6. Which brilliant Spanish general commanded the Army of Flanders in the Netherlands?

7. In which Spanish harbour did Francis Drake launch a daring surprise raid in April 1587?

8. How many Spanish ships did Drake destroy in Cadiz harbour in 36 hours?

9. What famous phrase described Drake's raid on Cadiz?

10. What vital naval supplies did Drake destroy at Cadiz that crippled the Armada's food storage?

• CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

HISTORICAL TERMINOLOGY

Treaty of Nonsuch: Key Disciplinary Concept | **Naval Pre-Emptive Raid:** Key Disciplinary Concept

Distinguish between an official defensive military alliance deploying standing troops to foreign soil (**Treaty of Nonsuch**) and an offensive tactical maritime strike designed to destroy enemy invasion shipping in harbour (**Pre-Emptive Raid**):

Sentence Starter: *While Treaty of Nonsuch established that..., Naval Pre-Emptive Raid operated differently because...*

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

Edexcel June 2022 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of the Treaty of Nonsuch (1585).

Target Guidance: *Point* (An official military alliance committing England to support Dutch Protestant rebels against Spain) • *Fact* (Elizabeth sent 7,400 soldiers under the Earl of Leicester and financed their campaign, officially ending covert neutrality).

Sentence Stems: One key feature was England's formal military commitment to the Dutch rebels... Specifically, Elizabeth agreed to send...

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

Edexcel June 2019 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of Francis Drake's raid on Cadiz in 1587.

Target Guidance: *Point* (A surprise pre-emptive attack on Spain's primary naval staging base at Cadiz) • *Fact* (Drake destroyed 30 Spanish warships and tons of seasoned barrel staves, delaying the sailing of the Armada by over 12 months).

Sentence Stems: One key feature was the devastating destruction of Spanish naval shipping... Specifically, Drake sailed directly into Cadiz harbour and...

Why did the Spanish Armada fail: superior English tactics or disastrous Spanish planning?

Key Topic 2.4: Spanish Invasion Plan, Ship Design, Fireships at Calais & Battle of Gravelines

Key Specification Focus: The Spanish invasion plan and leadership of Medina Sidonia; English naval design (Hawkins) and artillery; fireships at Calais; the Battle of Gravelines (1588); the reasons for the Armada's defeat.

• 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL DRILL (10 RECALL QUESTIONS)

Score: [/ 10]

1. How many ships sailed in the Spanish Armada in May 1588?

2. Who was appointed Commander-in-Chief of the Spanish Armada by Philip II?

3. What veteran Spanish army in the Netherlands was the Armada supposed to collect?

4. Who served as Lord High Admiral commanding the English fleet in 1588?

5. What naval treasurer revolutionized English galleon design with lower forecastles?

6. What long-range naval cannon allowed English ships to bombard Spanish galleons from safety?

7. What defensive formation did the Spanish Armada maintain sailing up the Channel?

8. What terrifying tactic did the English use at midnight on 7 August off Calais?

9. What decisive naval battle was fought on 8 August 1588 off the Flemish coast?

10. What route were the surviving Spanish ships forced to take back to Spain?

• CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

HISTORICAL TERMINOLOGY

Race-Built Galleon: Key Disciplinary Concept | **Crescent Formation:** Key Disciplinary Concept

Distinguish between John Hawkins' agile English warship design built for speed and long-range culverin broadsides (**Race-Built Galleon**) and Medina Sidonia's defensive naval convoy designed to protect supply carracks and facilitate grappling (**Crescent Formation**):

Sentence Starter: *While Race-Built Galleon established that..., Crescent Formation operated differently because...*

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

Edexcel November 2020 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of the Spanish invasion plan of 1588.

Target Guidance: *Point (A joint operation requiring the Armada to rendezvous with the Duke of Parma's army in the Netherlands) • Fact (Medina Sidonia had to transport Parma's 27,000 veteran soldiers across the Channel on flat-bottomed barges to invade Kent).*

Sentence Stems: One key feature was the coordination required between fleet and army... Specifically, Medina Sidonia was ordered to rendezvous with Parma at...

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

Edexcel June 2024 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of the English fireship attack at Calais (7 August 1588).

Target Guidance: *Point (Eight burning ships filled with pitch and gunpowder were launched into the anchored Spanish fleet) • Fact (Spanish captains panicked, cut their anchor cables, and broke their defensive crescent formation, scattering into the open sea).*

Sentence Stems: One key feature was the psychological panic caused by the fireships... Specifically, Spanish captains cut their anchors and broke...

'The English defeated the Spanish Armada mainly because of superior English naval tactics and technology.'
How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

You may use in your answer:

• English fireships at Calais

• Spanish planning and leadership

(You must also use information of your own.)

1. CRITERIA 1: ENGLISH TACTICS & SHIP DESIGN

POINT 1

Explain how Hawkins' race-built galleons out-manoeuvred clumsy Spanish carracks, using long-range culverins on four-wheeled truck carriages to reload and fire broadsides rapidly at Gravelines.

2. CRITERIA 2: FLAWED SPANISH INVASION PLANNING

POINT 2

Explain that Philip II's plan was fatally flawed: Parma controlled no deep-water port in the Netherlands, meaning communication took 48 hours by horse and barges could not escape Dutch flyboat blockades.

3. CRITERIA 3: ADVERSE WEATHER & THE "PROTESTANT WIND"

POINT 3

Explain that south-westerly gales drove the scattered Spanish fleet into the hazardous North Sea; lacking anchors lost at Calais, dozens of galleons were wrecked on the jagged rocks of Scotland and Ireland.

Analytical Connectives: Superior English tactics and ship design were pivotal because... • Specifically, the deployment of fireships at Calais succeeded in... • Furthermore, at the Battle of Gravelines, English culverins... • However, Spanish structural blunders critically undermined the operation because... • Ultimately, while bad weather completed the destruction, English naval technology was the decisive factor because...
Word Bank: Spanish Armada • Medina Sidonia • Duke of Parma • Race-built galleons • Culverins • Crescent formation • Calais fireships • Battle of Gravelines • Protestant Wind

Timeline Mission: Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 6). In Milestone 6, sketch the blazing fireships drifting into Calais Roads and the shattered Spanish galleon.

NAVAL TACTICS & STRATEGIC MAP • THE SPANISH ARMADA (1588)

1. THE STRATEGIC ROUTE OF THE ARMADA: PLYMOUTH TO GRAVELINES & THE ATLANTIC RETREAT			
① The Channel (July): 130 Spanish ships in tight crescent formation sail past Plymouth and the Isle of Wight. English long-range fire inflicts minor damage.	② Calais Roads (7 Aug): Armada anchors waiting for Parma. Midnight English fireships scatter Spanish fleet, forcing captains to cut anchor cables.	③ Gravelines (8 Aug): Close-range artillery duel. English race-built galleons pummel drifting Spanish ships with rapid-fire culverins; 5 galleons sunk.	④ The Retreat (Aug–Sept): South-westerly gales drive Armada around Scotland and Ireland. Lacking anchors, over 40 ships wreck on Atlantic reefs.
2. NAVAL ARCHITECTURE: HAWKINS' RACE-BUILT GALLEON VS THE SPANISH IMPERIAL CARRACK			
GB English Race-Built Galleon (*Revenge*, *Ark Royal*) • Designer: Sir John Hawkins (Treasurer of the Navy) • Hull Design: Lower forecastles and aftercastles; streamlined hull for superior speed, maneuverability, and pointing into the wind • Armament: Armed with long-range bronze culverins mounted on compact four-wheeled truck carriages • Gunnery Doctrine: Trained gun crews could reload and fire broadsides rapidly from standoff range, avoiding boarding combat • Tactical Goal: Batter enemy hulls and rigging from safe artillery distance		ES Spanish Imperial Galleon / Carrack (*San Martín*) • Commander: Duke of Medina Sidonia • Hull Design: High towering wooden forecastles and sterncastles designed as floating wooden fortresses for infantry • Armament: Heavy short-range cannon and demi-cannon mounted on clumsy two-wheeled field carriages • Gunnery Doctrine: Soldiers fired muskets from high castles while gunners reloaded outside ship hulls (extremely slow) • Tactical Goal: Grapple enemy ships, board with veteran Spanish infantry, and capture vessels in hand-to-hand combat	

MASTER KNOWLEDGE ORGANISER • KEY TOPIC 2: CHALLENGES TO ELIZABETH AT HOME AND ABROAD, 1569–88

1. CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY & CONCEPTUAL DEFINITIONS	
• Papal Bull (1570): *Regnans in Excelsis*: Pope Pius V excommunicated Elizabeth, releasing subjects from loyalty. • Bond of Association (1584): Pledge by Englishmen to execute anyone involved in an assassination attempt against Elizabeth. • Singeing the King's Beard: Drake's April 1587 raid on Cadiz harbour destroying 30 ships and delaying the Armada by a year. • Culverin: Long-range English bronze naval cannon mounted on truck carriages for rapid reloading.	• Privateering: State-licensed raiding of enemy merchant shipping by armed private vessels holding letters of marque. • Treaty of Nonsuch (1585): Official military alliance committing 7,400 English soldiers under Robert Dudley to aid Dutch rebels. • Race-Built Galleon: Hawkins' streamlined warship design with low forecastles and agile maneuverability. • Battle of Gravelines (1588): Decisive naval clash off Flanders where English artillery battered scattered Spanish warships.
2. ESSENTIAL CHRONOLOGY	3. KEY HISTORICAL FIGURES MATRIX
• 1569: Revolt of the Northern Earls • 1570: Papal Bull excommunicates Queen • 1571: Ridolfi Plot uncovered • 1577–80: Drake circumnavigates world • 1583: Throckmorton Plot uncovered • 1584: Treaty of Joinville (Spain/France) • 1585: Treaty of Nonsuch signed • 1586: Babington Plot ciphers cracked • Feb 1587: Mary Stuart executed • July–Aug 1588: Spanish Armada defeated	• Sir Francis Walsingham: Principal Secretary & Spymaster General; uncovered Ridolfi, Throckmorton, and Babington plots. • Sir Francis Drake: Privateer, navigator, and vice-admiral; raided Cadiz in 1587 and commanded at Gravelines. • Duke of Medina Sidonia: Spanish grandee appointed by Philip II to command the 130 ships of the Armada. • Duke of Parma: Brilliant general commanding Spain's 27,000-man veteran Army of Flanders. • Anthony Babington: Catholic gentleman whose coded letters to Mary Stuart triggered her trial and execution. • Sir John Hawkins: Treasurer of the Navy; designed English race-built galleons and developed naval gunnery.

GRADE 9 EXAM TECHNIQUE MASTERCLASS • PEARSON EDEXCEL PAPER 2 RUBRICS

1. THE 2/2 MARK FORMULA: DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

EDEXCEL JUNE 2018 • TARGET: 2 / 2

Mark Scheme Law: 1 mark for identifying a valid feature + 1 mark for supporting historical detail.

Grade 9 Model Answer: "One key feature of the Act of Supremacy (1559) was that it made Elizabeth Supreme Governor of the Church of England [1 mark]. Specifically, this title was chosen as a compromise to appease both Catholics who believed only the Pope was head of the Church, and Puritans who believed Christ was the only head [1 mark]."

2. THE 12/12 MARK FORMULA: EXPLAIN WHY [12 MARKS • 18 MINS]

EDEXCEL JUNE 2019 • TARGET: 11–12 / 12 (LEVEL 4)

Three PEEL Paragraphs: Use both provided stimulus points + introduce at least ONE distinct self-selected knowledge point. Every paragraph must feature explicit causal reasoning words (*Consequently, As a direct result, This meant that*).

Level 4 Linking Formula: Do not just list reasons! Connect them causally: "*This economic grievance did not operate in a vacuum; rather, it directly exacerbated religious fear because...*"

3. THE 16/16 MARK FORMULA: EVALUATIVE ESSAY [16 MARKS + 4 SPAG • 25 MINS]

EDEXCEL JUNE 2022 • TARGET: 15–16 / 16 (LEVEL 4)

Criteria-Led Judgment Architecture:

- **Introduction:** Define the key terms, state your overarching thesis, and establish your criteria for judgment (e.g. short-term threat vs long-term structural instability).
- **Paragraph 1 (Agree with Statement):** Rigorously analyze the stated factor with precise dates, statistics, and historical names.
- **Paragraphs 2 & 3 (Counter-Arguments):** Introduce other critical factors (including required own-knowledge beyond the stimulus points).
- **Conclusion:** Weigh the factors comparatively! Never write "both were important". Explain why one factor was the foundational catalyst while another was merely a symptom.

★ **Examiner Secret:** High-scoring Level 4 candidates establish explicit criteria in the first two sentences: "*In evaluating this statement, success must be judged by whether the policy achieved long-term institutional stability or merely temporary crisis containment...*"

Section B: Question 3 • Evaluative Essay [16 Marks + 4 SPaG • 25 Mins]

'The main reason for the defeat of the Spanish Armada was poor Spanish leadership.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

Stimulus: • The Duke of Medina Sidonia • English fireships at Calais *(You must also use information of your own.)*

Remember to introduce additional knowledge beyond the stimulus (e.g. John Hawkins' race-built galleons, long-range culverins, or the Protestant Wind).

Quick PEEL Plan: Point 1: _____ | Point 2: _____ | Point 3 (Own Knowledge): _____

THE HISTORY DEPARTMENT • ASSESSMENT & PROGRESS RECORD

KEY TOPIC 2 ASSESSMENT & PROGRESS RECORD

PUPIL: 	TARGET GRADE:	PREDICTED:	ATTITUDE: 1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5
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#	ENQUIRY / LESSON ASSESSMENT	DO NOW (10M)	Q1(A) (2M)	Q1(B) (2M)	EXT (12/16M)	LESSON TOTAL
1	Enquiry 2.1: Plots and revolts at home	[/ 10]	[/ 2]	[/ 2]	[/ 12]	[/ 26]
2	Enquiry 2.2: Relations with Spain	[/ 10]	[/ 2]	[/ 2]	[/ 16]	[/ 30]
3	Enquiry 2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88	[/ 10]	[/ 2]	[/ 2]	[/ 12]	[/ 26]
4	Enquiry 2.4: The Armada	[/ 10]	[/ 2]	[/ 2]	[/ 16]	[/ 30]
KEY TOPIC 2 CUMULATIVE ASSESSMENT TOTALS		Do Now: [/ 40]	Q1(a): [/ 8]	Q1(b): [/ 8]	Ext: [/ 56]	[/ 112]

PEARSON EDEXCEL PAST PAPER PROVENANCE • COMPLETED EXAM YEAR LEDGER					
#	ENQUIRY / TOPIC FOCUS	Q1(A) FEATURE [2M]	Q1(B) FEATURE [2M]	EXT WRITING [12/16M]	YEAR DONE
1	Enquiry 2.1: Plots and revolts at home	Edexcel June 2018 (Q1b)	Edexcel June 2023 (Q1b)	Edexcel June 2018 (Q2)	[]
2	Enquiry 2.2: Relations with Spain	Edexcel June 2019 (Q1a)	Edexcel November 2021 (Q1b)	Edexcel June 2023 (Q3a)	[]
3	Enquiry 2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88	Edexcel June 2022 (Q1a)	Edexcel June 2019 (Q1b)	Edexcel November 2020 (Q2)	[]
4	Enquiry 2.4: The Armada	Edexcel November 2020 (Q1b)	Edexcel June 2024 (Q1a)	Edexcel June 2019 (Q3b)	[]

TEACHER FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT • WWW / EBI FEEDBACK		Effort Grade: []
WHAT WENT WELL (WWW): 	EVEN BETTER IF (EBI): 	
Teacher Signature: _____		Date: ____/____/2026

INTERACTIVE DIGITAL QUIZZING HUB • SCAN FOR INSTANT 20-QUESTION RETRIEVAL PRACTICE

Scan with smartphone camera to launch live self-marking quizzes

KT 2.1	KT 2.2	KT 2.3	KT 2.4	KT 2 VAULT
Plots and revolt... 20 Questions	Relations with S... 20 Questions	Outbreak of war ... 20 Questions	The Armada... 20 Questions	Master Quizzing 20 Questions